

Cabinet of the Secretary of State for Education

Decree-Law no. 55/2018, of the 6th July

The programme of the 21st Constitutional Government assumes as a priority the implementation of an educational policy with a people-centered approach, that ensures equity in the access to public education, thus promoting educational success and equal opportunities for all.

The fulfilment of these purposes, already included in the Education Act, approved by Law no. 46/86, of the 14th October, in its current wording, has been ensured by means of universally applicable measures. However, the available data show that the previously mentioned objectives have not been totally reached yet, since the right to education is still not fully ensured for every student. On the other hand, society is currently facing new challenges resulting from globalisation and increasing technological development. Accordingly, it is the role of school to prepare students, who will be the youth and adults in 2030, for jobs not yet created, for technologies that have not yet been invented and for solving problems that are still unknown.

Facing such an uncertain future, where a myriad of new opportunities for human development is glimpsed, there is a need to develop competences that allow students to question the established knowledge, integrate emerging knowledge, communicate effectively and solve complex problems.

Driven by such challenges and in order to answer this need, the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling* was approved following a broad national debate involving teachers, academics, families, social partners and students. This document establishes the matrix of principles, values and competence areas, to which the curriculum development must comply.

An inclusive school, promoter of better learning for all students and the implementation of the competence profile, which students are expected to develop, so that they can be able to exercise an active and informed citizenship throughout their lives, imply that schools are provided with autonomy for curriculum development, matching specific contexts and students' needs.

The achievement of meaningful learning and the development of more complex competences entail time for consolidation and curriculum integration. It requires not only valuing disciplinary knowledge, but also interdisciplinary work, the variety of procedures and assessment tools, the promotion of research, analysis skills, the development of presentation and argumentative skills, as well as the ability to work cooperatively and autonomously.

Being aware that there are schools, which have managed to counter the main predictors of school failure, by adopting solutions aligned to the contexts and to their students' specific needs, it is crucial to consider the curriculum as a tool that schools can manage and develop, so that all students can achieve the competences defined in the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. As such, it is essential that schools and teachers make the main decisions at curricular and pedagogical level. It is within the framework of this Decree-Law that schools are challenged, by granting them autonomy, so that, in dialogue with students, families and the community, they can:

i) Have greater flexibility in curriculum management, aiming to foster interdisciplinary work, in order to deepen, strengthen and enrich the Core Curriculum Competences;

ii) Offer the subject of Citizenship and Development in the different education and training courses aiming at an active citizenship, democratic participation, in intercultural contexts involving sharing and collaboration, as well as debate of ideas on current issues;

iii) Encourage students to develop research, assessment and reflection skills, as well as critical thinking and autonomy in the use of information, in order to solve problems and reinforce their self-esteem and well-being;

iv) Adopt different ways for organising school work, notably through the establishment of educational teams that make it possible to optimise teacher's work and focus it on students;

v) Foster project work and develop communicative learning experiences/communicative activities in oral, written, visual and multimodal form, valuing the role of the students as authors and providing them with meaningful learning situations.

vi) Reinforce assessment practices focusing on a variety of tools, which can provide more information about the effectiveness of the work developed and enable a follow-up of the first signs of student learning difficulty;

vii) Allow upper secondary students to choose their own course format by being able to swap and replace subjects within the scientific component of each course.

The full appropriation of curriculum autonomy, now granted, is always embodied in a flexible management of the curriculum structure and its alignment to specific curriculum options at school level.

Acknowledging the value of all curriculum subjects, the former exception to the rule regarding the assessment of Physical Education is now eliminated. This means that the assessment, in this particular subject, will count, alongside the remaining subjects, towards graduation from upper secondary education.

Likewise, the acknowledgment of the specificity and identity of the different upper secondary education provisions requires the end of mandatory examinations for specialised art courses and vocational courses, which target mainstream courses. Accordingly, upper secondary certification and higher education access are now separate. As a result, students taking specialised art courses or vocational courses are (only) required to sit examinations for higher education access.

By assuming that schools and teachers play a leading role in the students' learning process, the Ministry of Education undertakes a secondary role regarding the work of schools. Thus, this Decree-law establishes of a scheme to support, foster and monitor school work, by creating communities and networks for sharing practice across schools. Finally, and in line with the public sector priorities to cut out red tape and streamline procedures, it is now possible for schools to issue the templates for certificates and diplomas of the several education and training offers.

The present decree-law was subject to public consultation, involving public and private education institutions, higher education institutions, teacher professional associations, education community staff, national professional bodies, the Episcopal Commission, the Olympic Committee, the National Confederation of Parents' Associations, parents' and guardians' associations, union federations and individuals in general.

In addition, the following bodies were consulted: the National Education Council, the Council of Schools, the National Association of Vocational Schools, the Association

of Private Education Institutions, the National Association of Portuguese Municipalities and the self-governing bodies of the Portuguese Autonomous Regions.

Thus:

Following the legal framework established by the Education Act approved by Law no. 46/86, of the 14th October, in its current version and pursuant to paragraph c) of n° 1 of article 19th of the Constitution, the Government determines the following:

CHAPTER I

General provisions

Article 1

Object

The present Decree-law sets out the curriculum for primary and secondary education, the guiding principles for the design, implementation and evaluation of the learning process to ensure that every student acquires the knowledge and develops the skills and attitudes which contribute to the achievement of the competences outlined in the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.

Article 2

Scope

- 1- The provisions of the present Decree-Law apply to the several education and training provisions in primary and secondary education, in the scope of compulsory schooling, provided in public and private schools, including public and private vocational schools, hereinafter referred to as schools.
- 2- The present decree-law also applies, with the necessary adaptations, to e-learning, as well as to individual education and home-schooling.

Article 3

Definitions

For the purposes of this Decree-law, the following definitions shall apply:

a) "Multilevel approach" is a methodological option which allows access to the curriculum aligned to students' abilities and difficulties. This entails different intervention levels: universal measures, namely educational responses for every student; selective measures, designed to support learning needs, which were not covered by the application of universal measures; additional measures aiming to bridge prominent and persistent difficulties concerning communication, interaction, cognition or learning, which require specialised staff to support learning and inclusion.

b) "Core Curriculum Competences" entails the common set of knowledge, skills and attitudes that students are expected to develop per school year. This involves the attainment of structured, indispensable, conceptually aligned, relevant and meaningful core content knowledge as well as the development of skills and attitudes within each subject area or subject."

c) "Autonomy and curriculum flexibility" is the possibility provided to schools so that they can manage the primary and secondary education curriculum, rooted in curriculum structure and based on the possibility of enriching the curriculum with the knowledge, skills and attitudes that contribute to the achievement of the competences contained in the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.

b) "Curriculum reference documents" refers to the set of documents that embody the knowledge to be acquired, the skills and attitudes to be developed by the students, namely the syllabi, curriculum outcomes, guidelines, professional profiles and the references for the National Qualifications Catalogue (CNQ), as well as the Core Curriculum Competences for subject and/or subject area or (UFCD), short-term education and training courses. The latter (the Core Curriculum Competences) are the main curriculum reference as they provide guidance for the planning and delivery of learning, teaching and assessment.

c) "Domains of curriculum autonomy" (DAC) are areas designed for interdisciplinary work and / or cross curriculum alignment. They are drawn on the curriculum structure of education and training provisions and are guided by the

curriculum reference documents. The development of these areas results from the exercise of autonomy and flexibility. For this purpose, the teaching time for each curriculum component, subject area or subject is fully or partially allocated;

d) “Double certification” refers to the acknowledgement of the competences acquired, which can enable students to carry out one or more professional activities and be awarded a school diploma.

e) “The National Strategy for Citizenship Education” is a strategy aiming at the development of competences for a culture of democracy and learning, with an impact on the civic attitudes of the individual and on the interpersonal, social and cultural relations through the subject of Citizenship and Development;

f) “Curriculum structure” is the set of curriculum components, subject areas and subjects, which integrate nationwide study plans, to be taught per cycle of studies and year of schooling or per training cycle (the latter involves vocational courses). The curriculum structure also includes the expected teaching time for each year and cycle, which supports curriculum development, which is embodied in curriculum planning tools, at school level, in the classroom and with groups of students;

g) The *Students’ Profile by the end of Compulsory Schooling* is based on a set of principles, vision, values and general skills. It represents a common matrix for all schools, education and training provisions, in the scope of compulsory schooling, notably at curriculum level, contributing to the convergence and in liaison with the decisions inherent to the several dimensions of the curriculum development: the planning and implementation of the teaching and learning process, as well as the internal and external assessment of students’ learning.

Article 4

Guiding principles

The following guiding principles conduct the design, implementation and evaluation of the primary and secondary education curriculum, rooted on a common nationwide curriculum definition:

a) Fostering the improvement of teaching and learning quality, based on a multilevel approach, by means of a reinforcement of school curriculum management and in the formative nature of assessment so that every student is able to acquire the

knowledge and develop the skills, attitudes and values defined in the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*;

b) Implementation of an effective exercise of curriculum autonomy, enabling schools to identify effective curriculum options, aligned to the context, framed in the educational project and in other structuring school tools;

c) Guaranteeing an inclusive school, which fosters equality and non-discrimination, whose diversity, flexibility, innovation and personalisation meet the students' heterogeneity, eliminating barriers and stereotypes in the access to the curriculum and to the learning process, based on a multilevel approach, integrating universal, selective and additional measures to support learning and inclusion.

d) Acknowledging teachers as key agents of curriculum development with a critical role regarding its evaluation, reflection on the options to be taken, their feasibility and suitability to the contexts of each school community;

e) Students and parents' involvement in the identification of school curriculum options;

f) Fostering a better alignment of the three cycles of education, primary, lower secondary education and upper secondary education, assuming an integrated and gradual curriculum management;

g) Valuing the identity of upper secondary education as an education level, offering students a variety of academic options that aim at addressing their vocational interests, being stereotype free and allowing educational achievement at the end of compulsory schooling, labour market integration and the pursuit of further studies for all;

h) Mobilisation of education agents aiming at promoting school achievement for all students, based on curriculum co-authoring and shared responsibility;

i) Valuing an interdisciplinary and integrative approach to curriculum management and teaching, notably through the development of projects that combine cross-curriculum competences for different subjects, that are planned, implemented and evaluated by the teachers of the class or year of schooling;

j) Contextual flexibility in school work and student groupings, as well as curriculum management using the methods, approaches and procedures that are most appropriate, so that all students can achieve *The Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*;

k) Designing an integrative curriculum that aggregates all school activities and projects, assuming them as a source of student learning and competence development;

l) Valuing the course of students' education and the progress they have made, as a requirement for success and fulfilment of their best abilities;

m) Assumption of the importance of the transdisciplinary nature of learning, the mobilisation of different literacies and multiple theoretical and practical competences, promoting scientific knowledge, intellectual curiosity, critical thinking and intervening attitude, creativity and collaborative work;

n) Valuing the Portuguese language and culture as vehicles for fostering national identity;

o) Valuing foreign languages as vehicles for fostering global and multicultural identity and facilitating access to information and technology;

p) Valuing the community and the students' linguistic diversity, as an expression of individual and collective identity;

q) Assumption of arts, sciences and technologies, sport and humanities as structuring components of the curriculum structure regarding the multiple education and training provisions;

r) Promotion of citizenship and personal, interpersonal, and social intervention development education throughout all compulsory schooling;

s) Valuing collaborative and interdisciplinary work in the planning, implementation and assessment of the teaching and learning process;

t) Assessment of learning as an integral part of curriculum management and a tool for teaching and learning;

u) Fostering the regulatory purpose of external assessment, valuing a timely and rigorous intervention, supported by the information attained from the benchmarking process, in order to overcome difficulties in the different curriculum domains;

v) Valuing complementarity between internal and external assessment processes of learning;

w) Acknowledgement of the importance of internal and external assessment, as well as other specific types of assessment that convene external evaluators for the purposes of certification by the end of primary and secondary education;

2- The multilevel approach and its intervention levels are the object of the decree-law which establishes the legal framework for inclusive education.

Article 5

School year organisation

- 1- The school year corresponds to the period between the 1st of September of each year and the 31st of August of the following year.
- 2- The academic year is understood as the period within the school year in which educational activities are carried out, corresponding to a minimum of 180 effective days.
- 3- The academic calendar and the regulations the school year organisation must comply with, are established by order of a Governmental representative, responsible for Education.

CHAPTER II

Primary and secondary education curriculum

SECTION I

Design

Article 6

Purpose

- 1- The curriculum aims at ensuring that all students, regardless of the education and training provision they are attending, achieve the competences defined in *The Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.
- 2- In order to achieve this purpose, and without limiting the autonomy and flexibility exercised by the school, the following principles underlie the design of the curriculum:
 - a) Access to the curriculum by all students within a framework of equal opportunities, based on the acknowledgement that every student is able to learn and make progress in all learning areas.
 - b) Consistent and gradual learning;
 - c) Possibility of redirecting the course of education within the levels of education in which there are different education offers and pathways;
 - d) Assumption of the projects and activities developed within the school community as an integral part of the curriculum;

e) Granting upper secondary education students with the possibility of following their own course of education, by building their own academic course of education aligned with their interests;

f) Curriculum enrichment by means of providing an Extra Subject, through the creation of new subjects in primary education;

g) Fostering moments of support for student learning;

h) Access to the several components of art education;

i) Offering the curriculum component of Citizenship and Development to every student;

j) Offering Portuguese as a Second Language for students who have a mother tongue other than Portuguese and providing Portuguese Sign Language for deaf students;

k) Fostering the learning of Information and Communication Technologies;

l) The offer of Curriculum Enrichment Activities, in primary and lower secondary education on a playful, formative and cultural basis, is expected to be regulated, namely concerning its scope, by ministerial implementing order by a Governmental representative, responsible for Education.

3- So as to apply the provisions of sub-paragraphs (f) and (h) of the previous number, schools can use a set of time credits defined in the legislative order referred to in Article 5 (3).

Article 7

Education provisions and pathways

1- The education provisions of primary and lower secondary education aim to provide students with a common general education, which enables them with the development of the learning needed for further studies at the lower and upper secondary education levels.

2- These are the educational provisions of primary and lower secondary education:

a) General primary and lower secondary education;

b) Specialised art courses.

3- Education and training provisions in lower and upper secondary education, aim to provide students with diversified training and learning, according to their interests, under the assumption that every student is capable, thus they can choose any available education and training provision, so as to pursue further studies and /or integrate the labour market.

4- The education provisions in upper secondary education are as follows:

- a) Scientific-humanistic courses;
- b) Vocational courses;
- c) Specialised art courses;
- d) Courses with specific study plans.

5- Primary and lower and upper secondary education still comprise double certification courses, namely education and training courses for young people, aiming at the completion of compulsory schooling and the integration in working life, to which the provisions of this Decree-Law apply with the necessary adaptations.

6- The courses referred to in the previous number are created and regulated by Ministerial Implementing Order by Governmental members who are responsible for education and vocational training.

7- The running of the primary and secondary education courses under this Decree-Law, depends on the favourable opinion of the services of the governmental education area, with powers in the scope of the definition of the national networks of educational and training offers.

Article 8

1- The types of education in primary and secondary education are the following:

- a) e-learning;
- b) individual education;
- c) home-schooling.

2- The provisions referred to in the previous article and the types of education are subject to the Order by Governmental members, who are responsible for education and whenever applicable, by the area of vocational training.

Article 9

Education and training integrated programme

- 1- Aiming the fulfilment of compulsory schooling and the promotion of social inclusion, if further measures for fostering school integration are absent, an integrated education and training programme can be adopted, working within the scope of several education provisions, consisting of an inclusive socio-educational and formative measure, on a temporary and exceptional basis.
- 2- The programme indicated in the previous order by the members of the Government responsible for the area of education and labour, solidarity and social security.

Article 10

Changing the course of students' education

- 1- The possibility of changing the course of their education is guaranteed to students, by means of permeability among courses with similar study plans and according to the grade conversion, so that the student can pursue further studies in a different school course.
- 2- The process of readjusting the course of student's education is conducted by schools, according to the general guidelines by the Government member responsible for education.

Article 11

Curriculum structure

- 1- The primary and secondary education curriculum includes a curriculum structure presenting a set of curriculum or training components, subject areas, subjects, or short-term training units, to be taught in each year of schooling, cycle and level of education and training, based on the curriculum structure in annexes I to VIII to this Decree-Law and to which they belong.
- 2- The teaching time of the of curriculum or training components, subject areas and subjects embodied in the curriculum structure, serves as a benchmark to be managed by each school, through a redistribution of the time allocation presented in the curriculum

structure, based on the need to find the pedagogical answers appropriate to the school community context;

3- The exceptions to the teaching time understood as reference value are the following:

- a) the art specialised component, within the specialised art courses in lower secondary education and the scientific and technical art components, within the specialised art courses in upper secondary education.
- b) The technological component in the vocational courses;
- c) On-job training component of vocational courses and when it applies, specialised art courses in upper secondary education.

4- In the implementation of the provisions of paragraph 2, schools must ensure compliance with:

- a) The total annual teaching time per curriculum component within the curriculum structure which is distributed weekly. This total is equal to the product resulting from the multiplication of the total of the weekly time allocation by the number of academic weeks of the school calendar;
- b) The teaching time per training component within the curriculum structure - of the education and training provisions organised by training cycle.

Article 12

Curriculum autonomy and flexibility

1- In the scope of curriculum autonomy and flexibility, and subject to the provisions of paragraphs 3 and 4 of the preceding articles, schools can manage up to 25%:

- a) Of the total time allocation per year of schooling, concerning curriculum structures with weekly distribution;
- b) Of the total time allocation of the sociocultural and scientific components foreseen for the training cycle, concerning structures organised by training cycle.

2- The curriculum autonomy granted to schools, from 0% to 25% is developed at local level according to the initiative of the school.

3- Managing over 25% of the curriculum structure is also possible for schools, aiming at the development of curriculum, pedagogical or other innovation plans, such as alternative education pathways, dual certification courses, to be regulated by ministerial implementing order by a Governmental representative, responsible for Education.

4- The provisions of the legislative order for the organisation of the academic year concerning teaching time, are safeguarded.

5- The provisions of the previous numbers cannot result into an increase of teaching staff.

Article 13

Curriculum structure for primary and lower-secondary education

1- The curriculum structures for primary and lower secondary education presented in Annexes I to V, to this Decree-Law include:

a) In lower primary education, the curriculum components to be developed using a collaborative and holistic approach to teaching and learning. This approach is based on the practice of a generalist teacher and a specialist teacher who teaches English. It also relies on the development of innovative cooperation projects with teachers of this cycle or other cycles of studies;

b) In upper primary education, different subjects within subject areas, privileging interdisciplinary approaches fostered by the “two subjects” organisation of the teachers’ recruitment for this level of education;

c) In lower secondary education, different subjects within subject areas, privileging interdisciplinary approaches.

2- The curriculum structure includes the subject of Religious Studies as a compulsory provision of optional attendance.

3- In lower primary education, the curriculum structure entails Citizenship and Development and Information and Communication Technologies as cross-curriculum components, fostered by the holistic dimension of education. The latter has an instrumental nature designed to support learning development.

4- In upper primary and lower secondary education, the curriculum structure includes the components of Citizenship and Development and, as a rule, Information and Communication Technologies.

5- The Citizenship and Development component is expected to be developed, in accordance with Article 15th.

6- The curriculum structure still includes, in primary and lower secondary education, the component of Study Skills, which works as follows:

a) In upper primary education, it is rooted in the curriculum structure, as learning support aiming at the integration of several curriculum components and privileging research, information processing and selection.

b) In lower secondary education, as learning support. Schools decide whether to provide it, how to organise it, how much time to allocate to it as well as its attendance rules.

7 – The curriculum structure for primary and lower secondary education include the component of Extra Art Education, enabling:

a) In upper primary education, the possibility of providing other art subjects, throughout this education level, whose provision is decided by the school; and facilitating their organisation, time allocation and attendance rules, privileging, for this purpose, the available human resources;

b) In lower secondary education, the integration of the subject area of Art and Technology Education as a subject, aiming at the attendance of Technology Education and/or another subject within the art field, privileging, for this purpose, the available human resources.

8 – The curriculum structure for specialised art courses includes a specialised art training component in line with in its curriculum specification.

9 – In upper primary and lower secondary education, there is also the possibility of providing an Extra Subject aimed at the creation new subjects, with their own specific curriculum reference documents and identity.

Article 14

Curriculum structure for upper secondary education

1 – The curriculum structure of education and training provisions for upper secondary education are included in Annexes VI to VIII to this Decree-Law.

2 – The curriculum structure embodies a set of common subjects within the following education and training components:

a) The general component, in scientific-humanistic courses and in specialised art courses;

b) The sociocultural component, in vocational courses;

3 – The curriculum structure also embodies the following education and training components:

a) The specific component, in the scientific humanistic courses, which aims at providing consistent scientific education in the scope of the course;

b) The scientific component, in specialised art courses and vocational courses aimed at acquiring and developing a set of learning competences in line with the specificity of each course, namely the vocational profile associated with the qualification, if applicable;

c) The technical art component, in specialised art, and the technological component, in vocational courses that aim at the development of a set of knowledge and technical skills in line with their vocational profile, if applicable.

d) On-job training context in vocational courses, when it exists, in specialised art courses, held in companies or other organisations. This is carried out through working experiences via an apprenticeship supervised by a tutor, appointed by the host company, integrating a set of work-based activities and aiming at the acquisition and the development of technical, social and organisational skills, which are relevant to the intended professional qualification.

4 – The training components identified in the previous numbers may supply additional subjects according to each school's educational school project.

5 – The curriculum structure of scientific humanistic courses, specialised art courses and vocational courses include Religious Studies as a subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance.

6 – The curriculum structure also entails the Citizenship and Development, according to the provisions of the following article.

Article 15

Citizenship and Development

1 – In the scope of the National Strategy for Citizenship Education, the component of Citizenship and Development shall be developed according to the provisions of the following numbers.

2 – Each school has to approve its education strategy for citizenship defining:

- a) The domains, topics and competences to be developed per education level and year of schooling;
- b) The way of organising schoolwork;
- c) The projects to be developed by the students in the community and the competences they are expected to develop;
- d) Partnerships to be established within the community. building networks enabling the implementation of projects;
- e) The assessment of students' learning;
- f) The evaluation of the education strategy for the implementation of citizenship at school.

3 – The curriculum component of Citizenship and Development, integrating the structure of all education and training provisions:

- a) Entails cross-curriculum work, in an integrated way, using an interdisciplinary approach;
- b) Mobilises the contributions of different curriculum or training components of subject areas, subjects, or short-term training units. It aims at the intersection of the content learning of those subjects and units with the topics of the

National Strategy for Citizenship Education, through projects developed by students in each class.

4 – The school decides how to implement the component of Citizenship and Development in upper secondary education. Among other options, it can adopt the following:

- a) Its provision as an autonomous subject;
- b) The practice of co-teaching, within a subject;
- c) Overlapping Citizenship and Development with another subject;
- d) An approach, under the coordination of a class teachers or group of students, in line with content topics and projects of the different curriculum subjects.

5 – The options provided in sub-paragraphs a) to c) of the previous number are conducted in accordance with the provisions of paragraphs 1 and 2 of article 12.

Article 16

Tailored education pathways in secondary education

1 – Within the provisions of Article 6 (2) (e), upper secondary education students can be granted an education pathway of their own by having the possibility to switch and substitute subjects.

2 – The range of eligible subjects for switching include the subjects offered by the school in line with its education project.

3 – The rules and procedures regarding the switching and substitution of subjects, which enable a tailored education pathway are regulated, by a Member of the Government responsible for Education.

Article 17

Curriculum reference documents

1 – The curriculum reference documents set out the intended learning to be developed by the students in the different curriculum components, subject areas, subjects or short-term training units.

2 – *The Core Curriculum Competences* are curriculum guidelines for the planning, management and assessment of the teaching and learning process, in each year of schooling or training, curriculum component, subject area, subjects or UFCD.

3 – *The Core Curriculum Competences*, as well as the remaining curriculum reference documents, which are not subject to specific regulation, are approved by Order of the members of the Government responsible for Education and, if applicable, for vocational training.

Section II

Implementation

Article 18

Curriculum planning

1 – Curriculum planning is supported by the specific knowledge about the community where the school is located, aiming at adapting and contextualising the curriculum to the school's education project, as well as at accommodating the characteristics of the students.

2 – Regular monitoring practice of curriculum planning must be guaranteed so as to evaluate the impact of the decisions made, pursuant to the previous paragraph, in order to promote the necessary adjustments.

3 – In decisions made by the school concerning curriculum adaptations and contextualisation, the following is considered:

- a) The consolidation, deepening and/or enrichment of *the Core Curriculum Competences*, using the other curriculum reference documents in force;
- b) The development of the competences outlined in the references of *the National Qualifications Catalogue*, where applicable.

4 – The school's decisions are comprised in the curriculum planning tools.

Article 19

Priorities and core curriculum options

1 – Focusing on the competence areas outlined in *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*, each school, in the context of its community, sets out priorities and makes options within the development of curriculum planning aiming at:

- a) Valuing arts, sciences, sport, humanities, ICT and practical and experimental work, as well as embedding regional and local community components;
- b) Developing multiple competences, such as research, assessment, reflection skills, critical thinking and autonomy in the use of information with a view to problem solving and reinforcing the students' self-esteem;
- c) Fostering spoken, written, visual and multimodal communicative experiences in Portuguese and in foreign languages;
- d) Exercising active citizenship and social participation in contexts of sharing and collaboration and debating ideas on current issues;
- e) Implementing project-based learning so as to foster meaningful learning experiences and focus on the role of the student as an agent.

2 – The curriculum options of each school comprise, among others, the following possibilities:

- a) Partial or total combination of curriculum or training components, subject areas, subjects or short-term training units, using domains of curriculum autonomy, fostering time for interdisciplinary work and sharing teaching time across different subjects.
- b) Alternation, throughout the school year, of periods focusing on one single subject with periods focusing on several subjects, by means of collaborative work;
- c) Development of practical or experimental work splitting classes or using different organisations;
- d) Including projects developed at school in time units within the weekly teaching time, taking it in turns, or in another suitable way;

e) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation;

3 – In the implementation of the domains of curriculum autonomy, foreseen in sub-paragraph a) of the previous number, the existence of the subjects outlined in the curriculum structure shall not be impaired.

4 – The domains of curriculum autonomy are based on the curriculum reference documents of the curriculum components, subject areas or subjects involved.

5 – Organisational options of curriculum nature are registered in the school's education project.

6 – Schools must foster the students' involvement by defining procedures catering for their ongoing consultation and participation in the design of curriculum options and in the evaluation of their effectiveness in the students' learning.

Article 20

Curriculum planning tools

1 – The curriculum planning at school and at class level complies with the school's education project:

a) It is a contextualised appropriation of the curriculum, fostering learning and the students' overall development.

b) It records the planning, management and assessment decisions made regarding the teaching and learning process.

2 – In the accomplishment of the provisions in the previous number, schools must foster students' involvement.

3 – In addition to the school's education project, which embodies the core curriculum options, schools may adopt other curriculum planning tools.

4 – It is the school pedagogical council that makes the decision concerning the planning tools referred to in the previous paragraph, as well as, if there are any, the definition of their purposes and way of monitoring.

5 – The curriculum planning tools must be dynamic, synthetic and convey an interdisciplinary vision of the curriculum.

Article 21

Pedagogical approaches

- 1- The pedagogical approaches used must include the development of both interdisciplinary work and alignment across subjects. Where possible, this should be implemented by education teams accompanying classes or groups of students.
- 2- In the scope of their expertise, the education teams and their teachers are responsible for defining the appropriate pedagogical approach to work, having the characteristics of the class or of the group of students as reference.
- 3- Aiming at developing quality learning and embodying measures framed in the school planning tools, the following, among others, must be ensured within the educational action:
 - a) A preventive action, that allows the anticipation and prevention of failure and early school leaving;
 - b) The implementation of multilevel, universal, selective and additional measures, that are considered to match the students' learning process and inclusion;
 - c) Taking advantage of the resources and opportunities existing at school and in the community;
 - d) The adequacy, diversity and complementarity of teaching and learning strategies, as well as the production of descriptive information on students' performance;
 - e) Ongoing monitoring, evaluating the purpose and the impact of the strategies and measures adopted.
- 4- The educational action must ensure students' involvement, underlining civic intervention, privileging free initiative, autonomy, responsibility and the respect for human and cultural diversity.
- 5- Bearing in mind the promotion of educational quality and effectiveness, different forms of organisation can be implemented, notably:

- a) Collaborative work, valuing the exchange of knowledge and experiences, through the following:
 - i) Co-teaching performed by teachers teaching in the same school year, education level, various education levels and subject areas;
 - ii) Temporary switching of teachers teaching the same subject area or subject.
 - b) The organisation of students in grouping arrangements aiming at the:
 - i) Acquisition, development and consolidation of specific learning, with a view to promoting the alignment between curriculum and training components, subject areas, subjects or short-term training units, on a temporary basis;
 - ii) Provision of support to studying and learning, based on a methodology which integrates the learning of several curriculum components and subject areas, privileging research, information processing and selection;
 - iii) Development of individual, pair and group work mediated by the teacher.
 - c) The implementation of mentoring, aiming at guiding the educational process, notably through the self-regulation of learning and adjusting the students' academic and social expectations;
 - d) The promotion of educational and vocational guidance actions, so that students may choose courses, areas and subjects that meet their vocational interests;
 - e) The implementation of actions to support the students' growth and personal and social development, also aimed at promoting health and the prevention of risk behaviours.
- 6- In primary and lower secondary education, co-teaching practices should focus on Art Education and Physical Education, in the case of lower primary education, and on Extra Art Education in upper primary and lower secondary education. This involves mobilising teachers from other education levels that belong to the recruitment groups within these areas and prioritising the available human resources.

Section III

Assessment of learning

Article 22

Purposes

1-Assessment, rooted in a formative dimension, is a part of teaching and learning. Its main purpose is to improve teaching and learning based on a continuous process of pedagogical intervention, in which the learning objectives, the expected learning outcomes and the assessment procedures serve as reference.

2-As a process that regulates teaching and learning, assessment guides the students' education pathway and certifies the competences developed, notably the acquired knowledge, as well as the skills and attitudes developed in the scope of the competence areas outlined in *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.

3-When assessment takes place, it requires that the procedures, techniques and tools used are diversified and adapted to the assessment purposes, object, recipients and the type of information to be collected, which can vary according to the diversity and specificity of the curriculum work to be developed with students.

4 – Either it is in the scope of internal assessment, whereby both the teachers and the school pedagogical and management bodies are held responsible for assessment, or within external assessment, conducted by external assessors or by the departments and services of the Ministry of Education, the different ways of collecting information about learning aim to achieve the following objectives:

- a) To inform and sustain pedagogical interventions, adjusting strategies that lead to the improvement of the quality of learning, aiming at promoting school success;
- b) To monitor compliance with the learning objectives defined in the curriculum;
- c) To certify learning.

5 – Subject to the specificities that distinguish internal from external assessment, in terms of student performance and curriculum development, the analysis of the data collected should value the additional information they provide so as to improve the quality of teaching and learning.

6-The rules and procedures concerning assessment in the various education and training provisions are regulated by Order of the member of the Government responsible for Education.

Article 23

Assessment

1 – Internal assessment of learning:

a) According to its purpose of information collection, it can be:

i) Formative;

ii) Summative

b) It mobilises various and appropriate techniques, tools and procedures.

2 - In addition to internal assessment, the external assessment of learning:

a) Generates information to be used for:

i) Formative purposes;

ii) Summative purposes.

b) Depending on the nature of each education and training provision, it includes:

i) *Provas de Aferição*¹;

ii) Final tests;

iii) National final examinations;

iv) Art aptitude tests;

v) Vocational aptitude tests;

¹ They are benchmark or standardised tests designed to assess learning progress in several curriculum content areas. They have a diagnostic and formative purpose and intend to bridge the gap between internal and external assessment. In doing so, they provide an early diagnosis of learning progress to all assessment stakeholders: students, parents or legal guardians, schools and enable effective action in the course of the student's education. (translator's note)

3 - The tests and examinations referred to from i) to iii) of b) of the preceding paragraph can be carried out electronically.

Article 24

Internal assessment of learning

1 - Formative assessment is continuous and systematic, and it must draw on a variety of information-gathering tools that are appropriate to the diversity of learning, to the recipients and to the circumstances in which they occur.

2-The information gathered for formative purposes underlies the definition of strategies for pedagogical differentiation, for overcoming students' difficulties, for promoting the students' integration at school and for supporting school and vocational guidance. This information allows teachers, students, parents or legal guardians and other legally authorised agents or institutions to obtain information on the development of teaching and learning, in order to adjust processes and strategies.

3 – With the purpose of grading and certifying learning, summative assessment comprises a global judgment about the learning attained by the students.

4-The global judgment leading to assessment does not impair the necessary provision of information, based on reports or summaries, of the learning progress made by students, their quality and strategies for improvement.

5 - Formative assessment is the main assessment type and it allows the achievement of privileged and systematic information within the different curriculum domains. In line with the information provided to parents and legal guardians, the students' involvement in self-regulation should provide evidence for learning support.

6- The curriculum reference documents referred to in Article 17 and in no. 3 of Article 18 serve as benchmark for internal assessment in terms of the planning, management and assessment of the teaching and learning process.

Article 25

External assessment of learning

1- External assessment has *the Core Curriculum Competences* as reference, as outlined in no. 2 of Article 17. It should also entail the students' ability to mobilise the knowledge and skills developed from integrating several curriculum content areas, with special focus on the competence areas outlined in *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.

2- The *Provas de Aferição*, which are universal and compulsory, are carried out at the end of years 2, 5 and 8 and they enable:

- a) To monitor the development of the curriculum, in the different areas, providing regular information to the education system;
- b) To provide detailed information on the students' performance to the school, teachers, parents and legal guardians and to the students themselves;
- c) To promote a timely pedagogical intervention to cater for the difficulties that each student may be experiencing.

3 - The assessment of primary and lower secondary students as well of those attending specialised art courses implies the sitting of final tests by the end of year 9 (lower secondary).

4 - The assessment of upper secondary students attending scientific humanistic courses implies sitting national final examinations, to be carried out in the terminal year of the subject, in the following terms:

- a) Portuguese, within the general component;
- b) Triennial subject within the specific component;
- c) Two biennial subjects within the specific component, according to the student's specific education pathway, or a biennial subject, within the specific component of the course attended and Philosophy.

5- The students' assessment of specialised art courses in upper secondary education includes the art aptitude test;

6- The students' assessment of vocational courses includes the vocational aptitude test;

Article 26

Assessment stakeholders

1 - All stakeholder with competence in assessment of learning have an important role in the process, namely teachers, teacher trainers, tutors and members of juries. Generalist teachers in lower primary education and specialist teachers in upper primary and secondary education teachers are particularly responsible for assessment.

2 – Schools must ensure the informed participation of students, parents and legal guardians in the assessment of learning process by systematically promoting the sharing of information, involvement and accountability of the various stakeholders, according to the characteristics of the school community.

3- With a view to organising the external assessment process, notably its coordination, planning and management, regional teams are formed, belonging to the National Jury of Examinations.

Article 27

Assessment effects

1 - Formative assessment supports the definition of learning strategies, by producing pedagogical measures aligned to the students' characteristics and to the learning to be developed.

2 – Formative assessment supports leaning by using detailed information on students' performance, which can assist their educational or vocational guidance.

3 - Subject to the provisions of paragraph 5, summative assessment shall be carried out at the end of each school term and shall enable a decision to be made at the end of the school year:

(a) In primary and lower secondary general education and in specialised art courses on the transition and approval of the completion of those levels of education or the reorientation of the students' education pathway, as well as on the progression in the subjects within the artistic training component;

b) In upper secondary education scientific humanistic courses and in specialised art courses, on the approval in each subject, the progression in the non-terminal subjects, the

transition to the subsequent year of schooling or the reorientation of the students' education pathway and the completion of upper secondary education.

4 - In vocational courses, summative assessment enables a decision to be made on the approval in each subject, module or training unit, the progression or reorientation of the students' education pathway, and the completion of the corresponding education level that takes place at the end of each module.

5 – Whenever schools adopt a non-yearly organisation of the subjects, summative assessment shall be carried out in compliance with the rules set out in the specific legislation.

Article 28

Assessment grading scale

1 – The information resulting from summative assessment is conveyed as follows:

- a) In lower primary education, there is a qualitative grade alongside a descriptive comment in each curriculum component.
- b) In upper primary and lower secondary education, there is a numerical grade on a scale from 1 to 5 in each subject,
- c) In upper secondary education, there is a numerical grade on a 1-20 scale for all the subjects, modules, short-term training units and on-job training.
- d)

2-In lower primary education, Information and Communication Technologies is not subject to summative assessment given its instrumental nature.

3 - The options of each school that result in the creation of new subjects are subject to the provisions of paragraph 1.

3 - As regards upper secondary education, regardless the options taken by school, pursuant to article 15, paragraph 4, the subject of Citizenship and Development is not object of summative assessment; the participation carried out in the projects developed in this scope is registered in the student's certificate.

Article 29

Transition and retention

1 - The progress of the students' education pathway in primary and lower secondary education is organised by education level. Accordingly, every student who has developed the learning intended for each education level progresses to the subsequent one.

2 - If the student does not develop the learning intended for a non-terminal year of the education level that is critical for the development of the learning intended for the subsequent year, the lower primary education teacher, after hearing the council of teachers, or the class council, in the upper primary and lower secondary education, may, exceptionally, determine the student's retention in the same year of schooling. It is still decided, in the case of lower primary education if there are advantages for the students to accompany the class.

3 - The provision in the previous number does not apply to the 1st year of schooling.

4 – In case of retention, the curriculum planning tool for the class in which the student is to be integrated in the subsequent year of schooling shall provide multilevel measures of curriculum access, defining the teaching and learning strategies and the educational resources suitable for the full development of learning.

5 - Whenever the student attending scientific humanistic courses and specialised art courses does not satisfy the transition requirements, the curriculum planning tool for the class in which the student will be integrated in the subsequent school year follows what has been stated in the previous number.

6 - The Religious Studies subject is not considered for the purpose of student progression.

Article 30

Approval and completion

1 - The completion of lower secondary general education and specialised art courses in upper primary and lower secondary education depends on the completion of final examinations for subjects under external assessment.

2 - The completion of upper secondary education depends on:

- a) As regards scientific humanistic courses - national final examinations of subjects under external assessment;
- b) As regards specialised art courses - approval in the art aptitude test and, according to the art field, approval in the on-job training component;
- c) In vocational courses, approval in the vocational aptitude test and in the on-job training component;

Article 31

Diplomas and certificates

1-Students who finish primary and secondary education in the several education and training provisions and types are awarded a diploma and a certificate with the identification of the qualification level, according to the National Qualifications Framework as well as its corresponding level in European Qualifications Framework.

2-The diploma and certificate templates are usually issued in electronic format, under the terms to be regulated by Order by the members of the Government responsible for Education, and whenever applicable, for vocational training.

3-The issuing of diplomas and certificates shall be carried out by school the administrative and management body, or by the pedagogical management body in the case of private education institutions as well as vocational schools.

4-At the students' request, transcripts of the acquired qualifications can also be issued at any time during the school year.

5- Issuing the transcripts mentioned in the previous paragraph involves a cost to be fixed by Order of the members of the Government responsible for Finance and Education, which is considered to be part of the school's own revenue.

Article 32

Access to final tests and national final examinations

- 1 – As provided for in no. 3 of Article 25, access to the primary and lower secondary education final tests is guaranteed to the students whose education and training provisions do not require sitting high-stakes tests in case they intend to pursue further studies in other education pathways.
- 2 – Upper secondary education students attending the courses regulated by this Decree-Law can take national final examinations in the subjects they choose for higher education admission. They can do so as external students, pursuant to the Regulations for external assessment and *Provas de equivalência à frequência*² in primary and lower secondary education, approved by legislative order by the Government representative of the Ministry of Education.

Chapter III

Final and transitional provisions

Article 33

Monitoring and evaluation

- 1- The monitoring of the application of this Decree-law at national level is ensured by a team that gathers competences attached to the different departments and agencies of the Ministry of Education. It is a close monitoring locally assisted by coordinators who liaise with the national team and the schools, preferably schools organised in networks, teachers and local partners,.
- 2- In the monitoring process, the sharing, collaboration and dissemination of practices between schools are privileged, with emphasis on the scientific, didactic and pedagogical dimensions.
- 3- The monitoring and evaluation process takes place throughout a period of six years, with a mid-term evaluation carried out every two years.

² *Provas de equivalência à frequência* are tests administered at school level which are aimed at assessing the knowledge of the students at a specific school subject during a whole school year. (translator's note)

- 4- The team and the coordinators referred to in no. 1 are appointed and their territorial scope of intervention is defined by legislative order by the member of the Government responsible for Education,

Article 34

Legal References

The references contained in this document concerning the governing, administration and management bodies of public education institutions, as well as the coordination and supervision structures, shall be deemed equivalent to the organs and structures in each private education institution and to public and private vocational schools.

Article 35

Autonomous regions

- 1-The application of this Ministerial Implementing Order to the Autonomous Regions of Azores and Madeira shall be carried out subject to the competences of the respective governmental bodies in Education.
- 2-The monitoring team referred to in Article 33 may include members to be appointed by the Autonomous Regions of the Azores and Madeira.

Article 36

Transitory provision

Without impairing the provisions of the following article, the following rules remain in rule:

- 1) Adult education and training courses;
- 2) Primary and lower secondary education in adult education courses.

Article 37

Repeal provision

The following shall be repealed:

- a) Decree-Law no. 139/2012, of the 5th July, in its current wording, according to the production scheduling established in the following article;
- b) Articles 4 and 5 of Decree-Law no. 176/2012, of the 2nd August, in its current wording;
- c) Ministerial Implementing Order no. 341/2015, of the 9th October.

Article 38

Production of legal effects

1-The present Decree-Law takes effect as from:

- a) 2018/2019 for years 1, 5, 7 and 10;
- b) 2019/2020 for years 2, 6, 8 and 11;
- c) 2020/2021 for years 3, 9 and 12;
- d) 2021/2022 for year 4.

2- Subject to the provisions of the preceding paragraph the classes belonging to the schools comprised in Legislative Order no. 5908/2017, of the 5th July 2017, the provisions of this Decree-law come into force in:

- a) 2018/2019 for years 2, 6, 8 and 11;
- b) 2019/2020 for years 3, 9 and 12;
- c) 2020/2021 for year 4;

1- In the case of education and training provisions organised by training cycle, the references to years 10, 11 and 12 correspond to years 1, 2 and 3 of the training cycle, respectively.

Article 39

Implementation

The present Decree-Law enters into force on the day of its publication.

Read and approved by the Council of Ministers on the 24th of May 2018 — *António Luís Santos da Costa* — *António Manuel Veiga dos Santos Mendonça Mendes* — *Tiago Brandão Rodrigues* — *José António Fonseca Vieira da Silva*.

Promulgated on the 17th June 2018.

To be published.

The President of the Republic, Marcelo Rebelo de Sousa

Ratified on July 2, 2018.

The Prime Minister, *António Luís Santos da Costa*.

Annex I

(In reference to no. 1 article 11 and no.1 and article 13)

Primary and lower secondary general education

Lower primary

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*.

Curriculum components b)	Weekly teaching time (a)	
	Years 1 and 2	Years 3 and 4
Portuguese	7 hours	7 hours
Maths	7 hours	7 hours
<i>Estudo do Meio</i> ³	3 hours	3 hours
Art Education and Physical Education	5 hours	5 hours
Study Skills (c)/Extra Subject (d)	3 hours	1 hours
English	--	2 hours
Citizenship and Development	(e)	(e)
Total (f)	25 hours	25 hours
Religious Studies (h)	1 hour	1 hour

- During the four years of schooling, this compulsory provision of optional Curricular Enrichment Activities (AEC), with a weekly teaching time of five hours, to be developed in primary and lower secondary education, with a playful, formative and cultural nature.
- The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- The school has the possibility to anticipate co-teaching in Art Education and in Physical Education, whenever it is appropriate, prioritising, for this purpose, the available human resources
- Study Skills is a support to the learning process, based on a methodology of integrating several curriculum components, privileging research, information processing and selection.
- The new components created by the school for the teaching time allocated to the Extra Subject have their own specific curriculum reference documents and identity.
- Cross-curriculum integration areas, enhanced by the global dimension of education in this cycle.

³ A combination of Science, History, Geography (translator's note)

- g) Each school manages, within its autonomy, the teaching time within the curriculum structure, so that the total of the learning component incorporates the time inherent to the break between learning activities with the exception of the lunch break.
- h) Compulsory subject of optional attendance.

Annex II

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 13)

Primary and lower secondary general education

Upper primary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components(b)	Weekly teaching Time (a)		
	Year 5	Year 6	Total per education level
Subject areas/Subjects:			
Languages and Social Studies	525	525	1050
Portuguese			
English			
Portuguese, History and Geography			
Citizenship and Development			
Maths and Science	350	350	700
Maths			
Science			
Art and Technology Education	325	325	650
Visual Arts			

Technology Education			
Music			
ICT (b)			
Physical Education	150	150	300
Religious Studies (c)	(45)	(45)	(90)
Total	1350 (1395)	1350 (1395)	2700 (2790)
Extra Subject.....	(d)	(d)	
Study Skills (e).....	100	100	200
Extra Art Education (f)--	100	100	200

- f) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- g) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub-paragraph e).
- h) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes, to be organised and defined by the school.
- i) Component aimed at the creation of new subject(s) to enrich the curriculum, using the set of time credits. Subject(s) of compulsory provision and optional attendance if created.
- e) Component aimed at providing learning support. Schools decide whether to provide it, how to organise it, how much time to allocate to it as well as its attendance rules.

f) Component that allows the attendance of other fields of art education across this education level. Schools decide whether to provide it, how to organise it, how much time to allocate to it as well as its attendance rules, prioritising the available human resources through the use of the set of time credits.

Annex III

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no.1, article 13)

Primary and lower secondary general education

Lower secondary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding

Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of the *Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components (b)	Weekly teaching time (a) (minutes)			
	Year 7	Year 8	Year 9	Total per education level
Subject areas:/Subjects:				
	200	200	200	600
Portuguese.....	250	250	250	750
Foreign Languages:				
English				
Foreign Language II				
Social Studies	275	225	225	725
History				
Geography				
Citizenship and Development				
Maths	200	200	200	600
Physical and Natural Sciences	250	300	300	850
Science				
Physics and Chemistry				
Art and Technology Education:	175	175	175	525
Visual Arts				
Extra Art Education(c)				
ICT				
Physical Education	150	150	150	450
Religious Studies (d).....	(d)	(d)	(d)	
Total	1500	1500	1500	4500
Extra Subject	(e)	(e)	(e)	

- a) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- b) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub- paragraph e).
- c) Provision of Technology Education and/or other area of the art education, prioritising the available human resources.
- d) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes.
- e) Component aimed at the creation of new subject(s) to enrich the curriculum, using the set of time credits. The new subjects, created by school for the teaching time allocated to the Extra Subject, have their own specific curriculum reference documents and identity. Subject(s) of compulsory provision and optional attendance if created.

Annex IV

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 13)

Specialised art courses

Upper primary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. . Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components(b)	Weekly teaching Time (a) (a) (minutes)		
	Year 5	Year 5	Total per education level
Subject areas/ Subjects:			
Languages and Social Studies	550	550	1100
Portuguese			
English			
Portuguese, History and Geography			
Citizenship and Development			

Maths and Science	350	350	700
Maths			
Science			
Visual Arts	90	90	180
Physical Education (c)	135	135	270
Specialised art training.....	315 a 630	315 a 630	630 a 1260
Religious Studies (d)	(d)	(d)	
(e).....	45 (e)	45 (e)	90
Total (f)	1485 a 1710	1485 a 1710	2970 a 3420
Extra Subject	(g)	(g)	

- a) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum, except for the specialised art training component. Whenever students attend classes not exclusively formed by students of specialised art education, they attend the subjects of non-vocational subject areas, with the teaching time adopted in primary and lower secondary education, in the class they are attending.
- b) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub-paragraph e).
- c) Inexistent in dance training.
- d) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes
- e) Optional teaching time offer, to be used, fully or partially, in the component of specialised art training in joint activities or in the reinforcement of collective subjects.
- f) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time which is less than the total in the structure, so schools decide how to manage the remaining time, to be used to reinforce the curriculum components, except for the specialised art training component.
- g) Component aimed at the creation of new subject(s) to enrich the curriculum, using the set of time credits. The new subjects, created by school for the teaching time aimed at Extra Subject, have their own specific curriculum reference documents and identity. Subject(s) of compulsory provision and optional attendance if created.

Annex V

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 13)

Specialised art courses

Lower secondary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. . Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components (b)	Weekly teaching time (a) (minutes)			
	Year 7	Year 8	Year 9	Total per education level
Subject areas:/Subjects:				
Portuguese.....	200	200	200	600
Foreign Languages:	225	225	225	675
English				
Foreign Language II				
Social Studies	250	250	275	775
History				
Geography, Citizenship and Development				
Maths	200	200	200	600
Physical and Natural Sciences:	225	225	225	675
.....				
Science				
Physics and Chemistry				
Visual Arts(c)	90	90	90	270
Physical Education (d).....	135	135	135	405
Specialised Art Education	315 a 720	315 a 810	315 a 990	945 a 2520

Religious Studies (e)....	(e)	(e)	(e)	
(f).....	45 (f)	45 (f)	45 (f)	135
Total (g)	1575 a 1980	1575 a 2070	1575 a 2250	4725 a 6300
Extra Subject	(h)	(h)	(h)	

- a) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum, except for the specialised arttraining component. Whenever students attend classes not exclusively formed by students attending specialised art education courses, they attend the subjects of non-vocational subject areas, with the teaching time adopted in primary and lower secondary Education, in the class they are attending.
- b) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub-paragraph e).
- c) Subject of optional attendance, depending on the parents' decision, as well as on the availability of the school, to be made at course enrolment (upper secondary education).
- d) Inexistent in dance training.
- e) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes, to be organised according to the time unit defined by the school.
- f) Optional teaching time offer, to be used, fully or partially, in the component of art training specialised in joint activities or in the reinforcement of collective subjects.
- g) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time which is less than the total in the structure, so schools decide how to manage the remaining time, to be used to reinforce the curriculum components, except for the specialised art training component.
- h) Component aimed at the creation of new subject (s) to enrich the curriculum, using the set of time credits. The new subjects, created by school for the teaching time allocated to the Extra Subject, have their own specific curriculum reference documents and identity. Subject (s) of compulsory provision and optional attendance if created.

Annex VI

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 14)

Scientific humanistic courses

Upper secondary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components (b)		Weekly teaching time (a) (minutes)		
		Year 10	Year 11	Year 12
General:	Citizenship and Development (k)			
Portuguese		180	180	200
Foreign Language I, II or III (c)...		150	150	-
Philosophy.....		150	150	-
Physical Education		150	150	150
Specific:				
Triennial		250	250	270
Options (d):				
Biennial 1.....		270 or 315	270 or 315	
Biennial 2.....		270 or 315	270 or 3	
Options (e):			15	
Annual 1				150
Options (f):				
Annual 2 (g).....				150
Religious Studies (h).....		(h)	(h)	(h)
Total (j)		1530 a 1620	1530 a 1620	1035

- a) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.
- b) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub-paragraph e).
- c) Students choose a foreign language. If they have studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, they will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education. In case they start a language, taking into account the school's offer, they can cumulatively continue Foreign Language I as an optional subject, under expressed acceptance of the increase in the teaching time.
- d) The student chooses two biennial subjects.
- e) The student chooses two annual subjects, one of which must be within the set of options stated in d).
- g) Offer provided in compliance with the school's educational project – set of subjects common to all courses.
- h) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes, to be organised and defined by the school.
- i) Depending on the options of the various general education courses.

- f) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time which is less than the total in the structure, so schools decide how to manage the remaining time.
- k) Curriculum Component developed with the contribution of subjects and training components.

Annex VII

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 14)

Specialised art courses

Upper secondary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Curriculum components (b)		Weekly teaching time (a) (minutes)		
		Year 10	Year 11	Year 12
General:	Citizenship and Development (i)			
Portuguese		180	180	200
Foreign Language I, II or III (c)		150	150	-
Philosophy.....		150	150	-
Physical Education		150	150	150
Scientific:				
Two to four subjects (e)				
Subtotal (f)		180 to 540	225 to 630	225 to 630
Technical art component:				
Two to five subjects (e)				
Subtotal (f)		225 to 1080	270 to 1080	180 to 1260
Religious Studies (g).....		(g)	(g)	(g)
Total (f) (j)		1305 a 1980	1350 a 2250	1035 a 2160 (h)

- a) The weekly teaching time indicated is a reference for each component of the curriculum.

- b) Organisation of the subjects functioning on a quarterly or semi-annual basis, or other organisation, according to article 19, paragraph 2, sub-paragraph e).
- c) Students choose a foreign language. If they have studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, they will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education. In case they start a language, taking into account the school's offer, they can cumulatively continue Foreign Language I as an optional subject, under expressed acceptance of the increase in the teaching time
- d) Inexistent in dance training.
- e) It comprises a biennial subject to be attended either in years 10 and 11, or in years 11 and 12, chosen from a range of options to be defined according to the course nature and the school's educational project, being able to integrate, according to its nature, the specific scientific component or technical art component.
- f) Possible timeframe for allocation of teaching time according to the curriculum of each course.
- g) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 45 minutes, to be organised and defined by the school.
- h) It can comprise, according to the art field, on-job training.
- i) Curriculum component developed with the contribution of subjects and training components.
- j) The sum of the hours allocated to each course results in a total time which is less than the total in the structure, so schools decide how to manage the remaining time to be used to reinforce the general component.

Annex VIII

(In reference to no. 1, article 11 and no. 1, article 14)

Vocational courses

Upper secondary education

Taking as reference the curriculum structure and the options regarding Autonomy and Curriculum Flexibility, schools organise their cross-curriculum work in an integrated way aiming at the development of *the Students' Profile by the End of Compulsory Schooling*. Schools organise the teaching time in the way they consider appropriate.

Training components		Weekly teaching time Training cycle (hours) (a)
Sociocultural:	Citizenship and	
Portuguese.....		320
		220
Foreign Language I, II or III:		220

<u>Integration area</u>		100
ICT/ School Offer (c)		140
Physical Education.....		
Subtotal		1000
Scientific:		
Two to three subjects (d).....		500
Technological:		
UFCD (e).....		1000 a 1300
On-job training		600 a 840
Religious Studies (g).....		(g)
Total (h)		3100 a 3440

a) Teaching time which is not limited by the three years of the training cycle, to be managed by the school within its pedagogical autonomy, ensuring the balance within the yearly teaching time in order to optimise module development, on-job training and flexibility projects.

b) Students choose a foreign language. If they have studied only one foreign language in primary and lower secondary education, they will be required to start a second language in upper secondary education.

c) The school decides whether to provide ICT or School Offer. The latter is of compulsory attendance and requires the management of teaching time, according to the need for reinforcing learning.

d) Core scientific subjects to be set in the training references of the National Qualifications Catalogue, depending on the professional qualifications to be acquired.

e) Short-term training units developed in compliance with training guidelines in the National Qualifications Catalogue, observing the guidelines of the National Agency for Qualification and Vocational Education, I.P., particularly in the transitional courses. For the latter, the three to four subjects defined in the study plans are kept, which have been published in the Ministerial Implementing Orders that created each of the courses.

f) Curriculum component developed with the contribution of subjects and training components.

g) Subject of compulsory provision and optional attendance, with a teaching time of no less than 54 hours, across the three training cycles.

h) The total teaching time for the vocational course may vary from a minimum of 3100 hours to a maximum of 3440 hours. In order not to exceed the maximum teaching time for the whole course, the teaching time for on-job training must be adjusted according to the hours for the subjects within the technological component.